(B 102)

Open Basic Education (Adult)

Environmental Studies

Level - B (Equivalent to Class 5)

National Institute of Open Schooling
A 24-25, Institutional Area, Sector-62, Noida-201309 (U.P.)
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A Word With Joy

Dear learner,

An initiative has been taken by the Government of India to provide life-long learning to neo-literates in the society after the success of Adult Education Programme. This program is designed for the age group of 15-35 years from the deprived section of the society, who have achieved or want to achieve basic education. It is specially designed for those people who have failed to get formal education and interested to take the opportunity of lifelong learning. It has been imagined to create a learning society by developing all aspects of personality like individual, social, commercial and intellectual. National Literacy Mission and National Institute of Open Schooling have taken first step in this direction and issued about 2.35 Crore of certificate in basic literacy assessment.

Efforts have been made to introduce an equivalency programme for those who are interested to continue secondary education through non-formal education. The neo literates will get opportunity to learn at equivalency centers through distance education.

Self Learning Materials have been prepared for three levels i.e. Level 'A', 'B' and 'C' (equivalent to Class 3, 5 and 8 respectively) for this programme by National Institute of Open Schooling. This learning material will create learning attitude in learner with information seeking aptitude. Learning environment is created here by joining hands with scientific technology.

You must have read the Self Learning Material of level 'A' (Class 3). This SLM is equivalent to Class 5, which describes various aspects of environment like Religion, Caste, Festivals, Tradition, Life Style, Indian Culture, Natural Environment, Basic necessities of humans etc. This book also discusses conservation and respect of Indian Culture, Our Social Issues, Indian States and Union Territories, Life of Plants and Organisms, Human body and internal diseases etc. A special attention has been given to life value and current issues like female feticide, environment conservation etc.

Easy and simple language has been used in this book in accordance with learner's capabilities and abilities. This learning material has total 15 Chapters. A self-evaluation test paper has been provided after every three chapters. A samples question paper is also given for practice for neo-literates.

A special thanks to the entire intellectual who has contributed in making this material useful and interesting. I wish bright future of all learners. I hope that you all will pay attention to read the learning material. Views and suggestions are invited for further improvement.

Curriculum Development Committee

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1

India's Cultural and Natural Heritage It's Conservation and Honour

We will learn in this lesson

- What is culture? Importance and conservation of culture.
- Culture and heritage.
- Cultural heritage and the need to conserve it.
- Countries natural heritage.
- Forest, wildlife – Different kinds of forest and wildlife found in India and its preservation.
- India's water and mineral resources.
- Need to conserve natural heritage.

1.1 What is Culture?

Our food, our clothes, our language tells us about our culture. The language that you speak or worship in, was not started by you. It was there from before. We have only adopted it.

All these things are linked to our culture.

Culture is a way of living our life, which we have got as a legacy from our forefathers. Art, music, literature, architecture, crafts, philosophy, religion and science have been received by us from our forefathers. Customs,



Woman Making Rangoli

traditions, festivals, all are a part of our culture.

Culture has two aspects – Physical, which can be seen and non-physical which is not visible. Physical part consists of costumes, food and household goods. Non-physical part includes ideas, ideals, feelings and beliefs. Culture also includes Art, Science, Music and Dance.



Gujrati Dance

1.1.1 Genral Characteristic of Culture

A. **Culture is learnt and acquired:** A Person generally receives social and cultural behavior from their forefathers. He obtains it from the group or society in which he lives, namely, how or which festival we celebrate we have learnt from our ancestors.



Festival of Lohri

B. **Culture is accumulated:** It increases from generation to generation: In a culture, knowledge is transferred from one generation to another. With the passage of time, more and more knowledge is added to it. Generation after generations carry it forward.

This circle keeps changing and develops as a particular culture. Earlier a joint family was the custom but gradually it is a nuclear family which is prevalent. Earlier women wore petticoats, lehenga, odhni but now they wear salwar-suit & pant shirts.



Joint Family



Nuclear Family

C. Culture Keeps Changing: Influenced by social environment, new knowledge, ideas and traditions are joined to a culture. With the passage of time changes are possible in a culture. You see the way a wedding is celebrated. Earlier during a marriage, the members of a marriage party stayed for many days but not any longer now.

With time and according to our needs we have brought about a change in these customs.

When our thinking changes and based on it there is a change in our culture also.

D. Diversity in Culture: Cultural diversity is based on religion, caste and geographical conditions. All religions and castes have different cultures. In the same manner people living in different areas have different culture.

Persons living in Jammu and Kashmir & Kerala have different costumes and mode of life.

Women in Kashmir wear salwar-suit and pheran. They use a kangri to protect themselves from the cold weather. Women in Kerala wear saris while the men tie a "lungi".

1.1.2 Significance of Culture

Culture is a part of life. It makes us a social being. Culture is linked to tradition, beliefs, life style and spiritual, physical attributes. It teaches us the meaning of life and how to live it. Human beings are the creators of culture and it is culture which makes a human, a human being. Culture through the medium of philosophy and religion brings us closer to truth. In our religiously devout Indians, faith is an integral part. They believe that through ritualistic worship all unfinished work will be completed. In this reverence there is also an element of fear. They believe that any wrong doings, not telling the truth or stealing will be punished. Culture is a continuous process. It is never ending. It is a way to live our life.



A girl offering prayer

Let's see, what you have learnt 1.1

I. Fill in the blanks:

i. Culture is a way of living life, which we got as a .....

ii. Customs ..... festivals are a part of our culture.

iii. There are two aspects of culture – physical and .....

iv. Culture is ..... from one generation to another.

v. Human beings are the creators of culture and it is culture which makes a ....., a human being.

II. Write any two general characteristics of culture.

i. _____

ii. _____

1.2 Culture and Heritage

Our forefathers learned many things from their ancestors. With the passage of time they have added their experience to it. Whatever is not important was removed. We have also learnt a great deal from our ancestors. As time passes, we keep on adding new ideas and new beliefs. Whatever we think is not helpful and important is removed. In this way culture is transferred from one generation to the next generation.

Any culture which we have inherited from our forefathers is called cultural heritage. Taj Mahal in Agra ,Swami Narayan temple in Gandhinagar, Qutub Minar, the Dargah of Nizamuddin Aulia and Red Fort in Delhi, Mysore Palace, Jain Temples at Dilwara (Rajasthan), Golden Temple in Amritsar, Sisganj gurudwara in Delhi,



Sarnath



Rameshwaram



Puri-Rath Yatra

Sanchi Stupa, Saint Francis Church in Goa, India Gate, Buddhist monasteries, Rameshwaram, Rath Yatra in Puri, temple at Dwarka , Badrinath temple, Royal Palace of Mysore, Ashoka Pillar, Fatehpur Sikri, Rashtrapati Bhawan etc is a part of our heritage.



Golden Temple in Amritsar



Dargah of Nizamudin Aulia



Mysore Palace

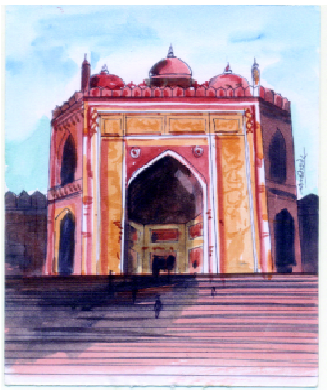
Literary works, buildings, sculptures and doctrines, knowledge of scriptures, scientific inventions and discovery are also a part of our legacy.



India Gate



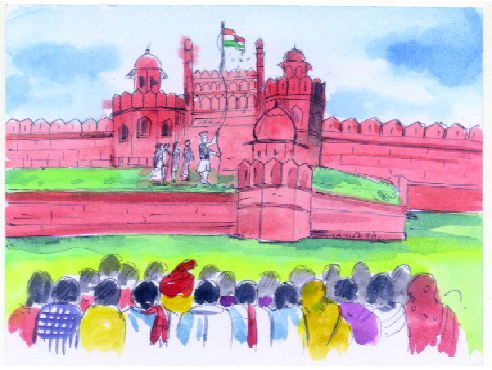
Ashoka Pillar



Fatehpur Sikri



Supreme Court



Red Fort

Aryabhatta, Varahamihira and Bhaskaracharya have contributed to India's mathematics, astronomy and astrology. Our religious texts like Vedas, Upanishads, Gita and Ramayana are our legacy. In culture changes keeps happening but not in our heritage.

Let's see, what you have learnt 1.2

Match the following placed with their monuments.

i.	Agra	a.	Golden Temple
ii.	Mysore	b.	Sanchi Stupa
iii.	Delhi	c.	Taj Mahal
iv.	Bhilwara	d.	St Francis Church
v.	Amritsar	e.	Qutub Minar
vi.	Sanchi	f.	Royal Place
vii.	Goa	g.	Jain Temple

1.3 Cultural Heritage and the need to preserve it

In India we find the remains of many monuments of ancient times. The remnants of Indus Valley civilization are scattered in different area.

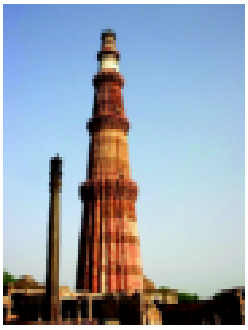
Sanchi Stupa and Buddhist monasteries at Sarnath were built thousands of years ago but in their ruins we can see unique examples of Buddhist Architecture. During the rule of Gupta dynasty, colored paintings were carved in Ajanta caves. These paintings are still preserved. These sixteen hundred years old caves are in Maharashtra. People come to see them from faraway places. Gateways of India in Mumbai is a historical memorial.

In Mahabalipuram, a chariot and temple has been made by cutting stone. Thirteen hundred years ago the Pallava Kings made a chariot and a temple at Mahabalipuram by cutting a stone. In our country, Kanyakumari is the last corner of our mainland. Over here is the famous temple of Kanyakumari. Both these historical places are in Tamil Nadu. Mysore Fort in Karnataka and Charminar and Golkonda Fort in Telangana are historical places.

Some monuments of our country are famous throughout the world. UNESCO has made a list of 830 world famous monuments and places. Out of this 20 are in India. Come, let us learn about a few important monuments.

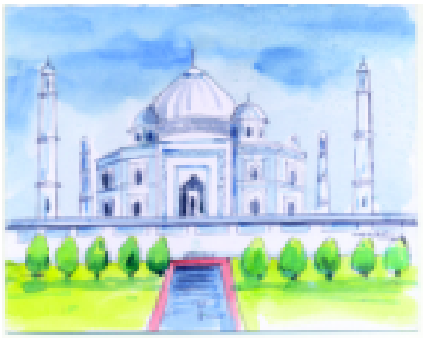
Qutub Minar

The world's tallest minar is in Mehrauli, Delhi. It is known as Qutub Minar. It is a five storey minar of red stone. It was built by Qutubuddin Aibak the founder of the slave dynasty. People from the country and abroad come to visit this monument made of red stone.



Qutub Minar

Taj Mahal



Taj Mahal

The Taj Mahal in Agra on the banks of river Yamuna is one of the wonders of the world. It was built by Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his wife Mumtaz Mahal.

Taj Mahal took 22 years and 20 thousand workers who worked constantly to build it. Taj Mahal has graves of Mumtaz Mahal and Shah Jahan.



Buland Darwaza

Buland Darwaza

Akbar founded the city of Fatehpur Sikri near Agra. Buland Darwaja in Fatehpur Sikri is world famous.

Bada Imambara

In Lucknow, near the bank of river Gomti is Bada Imambara. It was built by Nawab Asaf-Ud- Daulah. On the ground is a hall without pillars and on the upper floor are eight canopies. There is a maze in it.



Bada Imambara



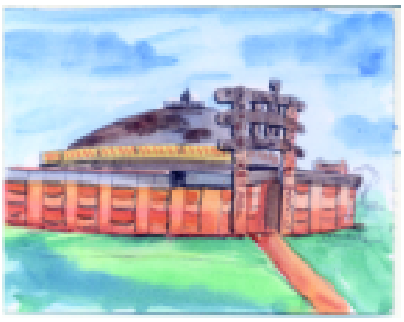
Golden Temple

Golden Temple

Golden Temple is in Amritsar, Punjab. It is the major pilgrimage centre of the Sikhs. The main areas of the temple are covered with gold. It has a holy pond. The devotees take a bath in the holy pond, listen to prayers (Shabad Kirtan) and pay obeisance.

Sanchi Stupa

The Sanchi Stupa is situated near to Bhopal in Madhya Pradesh. It was built by Ashoka. The Stupa is famous for its design.



Sanchi Stupa

Vivekananda Memorial and the Statue of Thiruvalluvar

Vivekananda memorial and the statue of Thiruvalluvar is in the Kanyakumari district of Tamil Nadu. Here the Indian ocean, Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal meet at a point. It is a beautiful place. It is a pleasure to watch the sunrise from here.



Sunrise at Kanyakumari



Saint Francis Church

Saint Francis Church

The old and famous church of Saint Francis Xavier, in Goa, near the capital Panaji.

Hawa Mahal

Hawa Mahal is in Jaipur, Rajasthan. It is a big latticed building. Its main characteristic is blowing cool breeze even in summers.



Hawa Mahal



Charminar

Charminar

The famous Charminar is situated in Hyderabad, the capital of Telangana.

Jantar Mantar

The Jantar Mantar observatory for astronomical calculation is located near Connaught Place in Delhi. It was constructed by Jai Singh the Raja of Jaipur.



Jantar Mantar



Ram Nagar (Varanasi) Fort

Ram Nagar (Varanasi) Fort

On the banks of river Ganga in Ramnagar (Varanasi) is a fort made of sand stone from Chunnar. Its garrets, pinnacles, huge entrance gate and palace are built in the traditional style.

Hamid Manzil



Hamid Manzil

Hamid Manzil is in the Rampur fort. Its tall, white dome endears our heart. We climb the wide huge stairs through the western side to reach Hamid Manzil. It has the world famous Raja Library where famed hand written scriptures are safely preserved.

Historical buildings and ruins are becoming old and shaky with time. These heritage sites are affected by the changes in weather.

Apart from environmental pollution, people are also damaging. Little attention is given to repairing and restoring these monuments.

Tourists damage these monuments by writing their names on the walls.

Some people also destroy and break things. Some make it their dwelling place. To preserve our heritage we should specially keep in mind that no damage is done to them.

The Government has set up a separate department to look after and maintain these heritages sites. It is called the department of Archaeology.

The Archaeology department maintains these places in a scientific manner. We must remember that any one department can not be make responsible for this work. It is the responsibility of each and every citizen of the country to be vigilant and help the government in keeping our heritage protected.

Let's see, what you have learnt 1.3

I. Match the following:

i.	Mumbai	a.	Charminar
ii.	Hyderabad	b.	Buland Darwaja
iii.	Fatehpur Sikri	c.	Golden Temple
iv.	Lucknow	d.	Gateway of India
v.	Amritsar	e.	Imambara

II. Answer these questions:

i. Where is the Qutub Minar situated?

. . . . . .

ii. In how many years was the Taj Mahal built?

. . . . . .

iii. Bada Imambara is on the Banks of which river?

. . . . . .

iv. Where is Buland Darwaja?

. . . . . .

v. Where is the holy pond?

. . . . . .

vi. In which state, the Sanchi Stupa is situated?

. . . . . .

vii. In Which city, the Charminar is situated?

. . . . . .

1.4 Come; Let us know about the Natural Deposits in the country

The countries natural legacy consists of flora and fauna, forests, mountains, plateaus and minerals. Rivers, drains, water sources, sea and desert are also included. We should take care of them. We should use them consciously. In the form of water, forests and land nature has gifted us immeasurable wealth.

1.4.1 Forest

Come; Let us learn about the different types of forests found in India

In India 23% of the area are surrounded by forests. A forest is a big terrain where dense trees and plants, vegetation as well as many kinds of wild animals are found.

Forest is an important natural resource for us. We get different kinds of wood, herbs, rubber, lac and silk from the forest. Forests also help in the rainfall. Forests help in checking land erosion and increasing the organic fertilization of soil. Forests provide protection habitation and food to the wildlife.

Our country has different types of soils and surfaces and also the different climate at varied places. That's why different kind of vegetation are found in our country.



Coconut tree on the seashore

In the Himalayan region, conical shaped trees like cedar, pine etc. are found. In the Terai region – sal, teak, bamboo etc. can be found. In the plains banyan tree, peepal, oak, rosewood, sandalwood, neem, woodapple (bael) are very common. In the desert region dates, acacia, hawthorn (nagfani) and keekar are found. Their bark is thick and rough. In the areas near the seashore we find palm, coconut and betel nut trees. In this way our country is rich in forest resources.

1.4.2 Wild Life

In the whole world we can find nearly ten lakh species of animals. From this 75000 variety of animals can be found in India. There are more than 1200 species of birds in India. In the forests of Assam, Kerala and Karnataka we find big elephants. Lions are found in the forests of Gujarat. One horned rhinoceros is found in the swampy region of Assam and West Bengal.

There are various species of monkeys and deer. Among the most beautiful animals are the four horned antelopes, gazelles and black buck. In the different variety of deer hongal, swampy deer, cheetal and missouri are included.

In the Himalayan region musk deer, yak, snow leopard, bear etc. can be found. In these areas we come across with wild sheep, mountain goat, saakin, musk rat and Tapir.

Peacock is our national bird which is found in abundance. In the damp soil, pheasants, geese, ducks, mynah, parrots, pigeons, cranes and sun bird are found. Many birds who sing like cuckoo and bulbul are found in these forests. Animals and forests have a deep relation. Different types of forests have varied kinds of flora and fauna. In the forest they get their food as well as a safe habitation.

In the tropical forests we find animals like monkeys, langurs that can climb. Elephants are also found in these forests. In the grass lands deer, swampdeer, tiger, lion, fox, rabbit etc. are generally found. In the Ice covered areas we find animals like musk deer, bears, wolf etc.

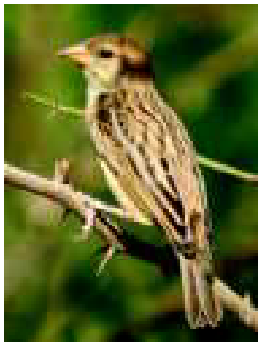
In the forest there are birds like mynah, parrots, cuckoo, sparrow goose, weaver bird, monal, eagles, vultures and falcons can be easily seen. A number of domestic and wild animals are with as our legacy.



Crow



Sparrow



Bird



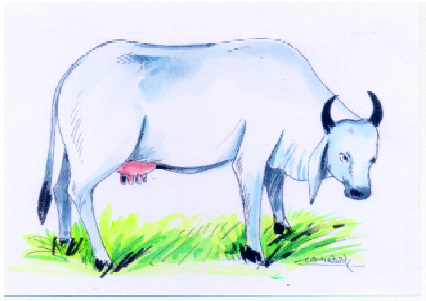
cuckoo



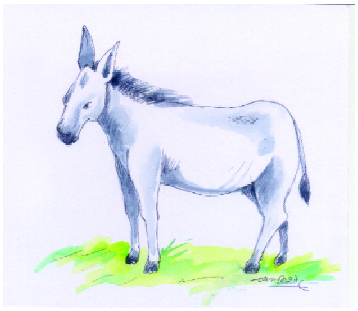
Parrot



Rabbit



Cow



Donkey



Elephant



Lion



Tiger



Wolf



Hyena



Rhinoceros



Crocodile



Horse

Where we have cow, buffalo, sheep, goat, camel, elephant, dog, cat as domestic animals. We also have wild animal like lion, tiger, leopard, bear, elephant, rhinoceros, deer, rabbit, yak, monkey and langur as our asset.

In our country we have 55 national parks. Corbett national park, Dudhwa national park, Kaziranga national park and Kanha Kigli National park are the major parks.



National Parks in India

1.4.3 Water Resources

The Himalayan mountain range is spread from Jammu and Kashmir to Arunachal Pradesh. Many rivers originate from its snow covered peaks and icy regions like – Ganga, Yamuna, Sutlej, Ravi, Chenab, Beas and Brahmaputra. These rivers have made Terai region of Himalaya's very fertile. In southern region of the country Krishna, Cavery, Narmada, Tapti etc. river flow. These rivers irrigate the different regions of the country.

India is surrounded by sea on three sides. There are beautiful and captivating beaches. In the east is Bay of Bengal, west has Arabian Sea and in the south the Indian Ocean is situated. India's sea coast is nearly 7000 km long. The flora and fauna, petroleum products, oysters, shells and pearls available in our maritime boundary are the parts of our assets.

1.4.4 Mineral Resources

Those products which we obtain after digging the earth are called mineral products for e.g. Iron, coal, petrol etc. The area where digging is done to obtain these products is called a mine or quarry.

These mineral products are found in an impure form in the interiors of earth. They are refined in a factory through various processes.

India is rich in mineral resources. Iron, Coal, Bauxite, Manganese and Mica is available in large quantities. Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh minerals are also rich in minerals.

Coal

Production of coal happened when millions of years ago the forests were compressed inside the earth. It is the main source of energy. Coal is used as fuel in a number of houses and industries. It is necessary to melt Iron ore. Coal is required in large quantity for the generation of electricity. Coal is also used in chemical industries as well as other industries.

We get coal from the quarries of Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh in India.

Petroleum

Petroleum is also found in the interiors of the earth. Along with petroleum and mineral oil there is natural gas also. We get diesel, kerosene etc. from unpurified petroleum. At present we require petrol or diesel to drive a vehicle on road, trains, aeroplanes. Mineral oil is used for production of electricity. Natural gas is used for vehicles as well as cooking the food.

In India petroleum is found in Mumbai (Maharashtra), Assam and Gujarat.

The petroleum reserves in India are not sufficient, therefore we have to import it from other countries.

Iron

In our daily life, the metal which is utilized most is iron. In different types of machinery, construction of buildings, construction of bridges, iron is required. In our country iron is quarried from the mines of Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha and Jharkhand.

Let's see, what you have learnt 1.4

I. Answer these questions

i. Why is the water of Ganga and Yamuna polluted?

_____

ii. Why are forests being cut?

_____

II. Fill in the blanks

i. We get herbs, rubber, lac and …… from the forests.

ii. In the desert forest the bark of the plant is …….. and ……..

iii. In the Himalaya region we find the …….. deer.

iv. Himalaya spreads from Jammu and Kashmir to ……..

v. We get diesel and …… from unpurified petroleum.

III. Answer these questions.

i. Write the name of any two trees that grow in the desert.

_____

ii. Cedar and pine trees are found in which region?

_____

iii. Name any three animals found in the grasslands?

_____

iv. In which regions coal is found in our country?

_____

v. Where is petroleum found?

_____



Let's Revise

- Culture is a way of life in which we think and work.
- Culture includes those legacies which we have got from our forefathers?
- Art, music, literature, architecture, crafts, philosophy, religion and science have been received from our forefathers.
- Culture has two aspects – physical and non-physical.
- Physical aspect consists of costumes, food etc. and non-physical includes ideas, ideals, feelings and beliefs.
- Art, science, music and dance, we have got from our forefathers.
- Culture is learnt and obtained. It is dynamic, ideological and keeps changing.
- Human beings are the creators of culture and culture makes a person a human being.
- Culture is transferred from one generation to another.

- This is our legacy. Delhi's Red Fort, India Gate and Qutub Minar, Mysore Palace, Jain Temples in Dilwara, the dargah of Nizamuddin Aulia, Golden Temple in Amritsar, Gurdwara Sisganj in Delhi, Sanchi Stupa near Bhopal, St. Francis Church in Goa, all are our legacy. It is our heritage.
- Aryabhatta, Varahamihira, Bhaskaracharya have also contributed in the field of astronomy and astrology.
- Our religious scriptures are also our legacy.
- In our country there are 55 National Parks. Corbett National Park, Dudhwa National Park, Kaziranga National Park and Kanha National Park are some famous National Parks.
- Flora and fauna, forests, mountains, plateaus, fields, sea, desert etc are our natural heritage.
- There are various types of trees, plants, flora and fauna.
- We must conserve our cultural and natural heritage.

Exercise

I. Fill in the blanks

i. We have got our social and cultural customs from our ……..

ii. As time passes, our culture also keeps ……

iii. Cultural…… is what we have received from our forefathers, generation after generation.

iv. Our ……. is our legacy.

II. Match the following

i.	Hamid Manzil	a.	Near Bhopal in Madhya Pradesh
ii.	Jantar Mantar	b.	Jaipur
iii.	Sanchi Stupa	c.	Rampur
iv.	Hawa Mahal	d.	Delhi
v.	Ashoka Pillar	e.	Built by the Pallava kings
vi.	Mahapalipwom	f.	Samrat Ashoka

III. Answer the following questions

i. What influences our culture?

_____

ii. What is legacy?

_____

iii. What is natural heritage?

_____

iv. How many national parks are there? Name any two of them?

_____

v. In which regions of our country is coal found?

_____

IV. Put a (✓) for true and a (✗) for false

i. Art, science, music and dance, we have got from our ancestors. ( )

ii. Culture is static, it does not change. ( )

iii. Human beings are creators of culture and so it is culture which makes a person a human being. ( )

iv. Pongal is celebrated in Kerala. ( )

v. Mahabalipuram was built by the Pallava kings. ( )

vi. Golden temple is in Delhi. ( )

vii. Sanchi stupa is in Madhya Pradesh. ( )

viii. Archaeological Department looks after our heritage. ( )

ix. The government has not done anything for the safety of animals. ( )

x. Pollution has also spoilt our heritage. ( )

V. Tick the correct answer.

i. Culture consists of what all?

a. Legacy from our forefathers.

c. Articles brought from abroad.

d. Articles made at home.

ii. Where is coal found?

a. Rajasthan

b. Kerala

c. Madhya Pradesh

d. Jammu

iii. Where is Buland Darwaza?

a. Mumbai

b. Delhi

c. Kolkata

d. Fatehpur Sikri

iv. Where is Sanchi Stupa?

a. Amritsar

b. Near Bhopal

c. Kanyakumari

d. Bhubneshwar

ANSWERS

Let see, what you have learnt

1.1 I. i. Legacy from our forefathers ii. Traditions

iii. Non – Physical iv. Transferred

v. Human

II. i. Culture is learnt and received.

ii. Culture keeps changing.

1.2 i. C ii. F iii. E

iv. G v. A vi. B

vii. D

1.3 I. A - IV

B - I

C - II

D - V

E - III

II. i. Delhi ii. 22 Years

iii. Gomti iv. Fatehpur Sikri

v. Amritsar vi. Madhya Pradesh

vii. Hyderabad

1.4 I. i. Sewage water and garbage from the factories and homes.

ii. Because of the increasing population in the cities.

II. i. Silk ii. Thick, Rough

iii. Musk iv. Arunachal Pradesh

v. Kerosene

III. i. Date, Babool ii. Himalaya

iii. Deer, Tiger, Lion iv. Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh

v. Mumbai, Assam, Gujarat.

Exercise

I. i. Forefathers ii. Changing

iii. Legacy iv. Religious Scriptures.

II. i – c , ii - d, iii - a, iv – b, v - f, vi – e

III. i. Physical and Social environment

ii. What we have received from our forefathers.

iii. Flora and Fauna, Forests, Mountains, Plateaus, Fields and Minerals.

iv. 55 National Parks

a. Corbett

b. Dudhwa

v. Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand.

IV. i. ✓ ii. ✘

iii. ✓ iv. ✘

v. ✓ vi. ✘

vii. ✘ vii. ✓

ix. ✘ x. ✓

V. i – a, ii – b, iii – c, iv - d

2

Peace, Unity and Harmony in Indian Society

We will learn in this lesson

- People of India.
- Our customs
- Our mixed culture - sense of Unity in Diversity.
- Meaning of peace and harmony.
- Effort made by Samrat Ashoka and Emperor Akbar for Peace, Harmony and Brotherhood.

India is a nation of diversities. People of different races, community and caste live here. They live in different geographical areas and speak different languages. They believe in different religions and follow their characteristics. There is a lot of variety in their way and style of living and food habits.



Followers of different religions and religious places

Inspite of these diversities, we all are Indians. The people may have different religious identity like Hindu, Muslim, Christian, Sikh, Budh and Parsi. They can also have different regional identity in the form of Punjabi, Tamil, Bengali, Manipuri or South Indian, North Indian or north-east Indian, but their national identity is paramount.

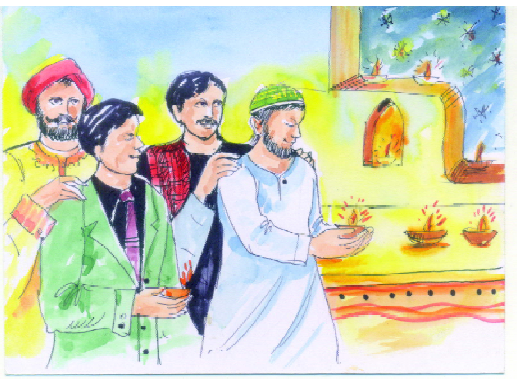
Unity is more important for the nation, which has social, cultural, religious, linguistic and geographical diversities. India

is the second most populated country in the world. People from all religions of the world like Hindu, Muslim, Christian, Bodh, Jain, Sikh and Parsi live here. More than 850 languages and dialects are spoken and their attire, food habits and social customs are also vastly varied.

Come, let us know in this lesson about the customs unity in diversity, peace and harmony of India.

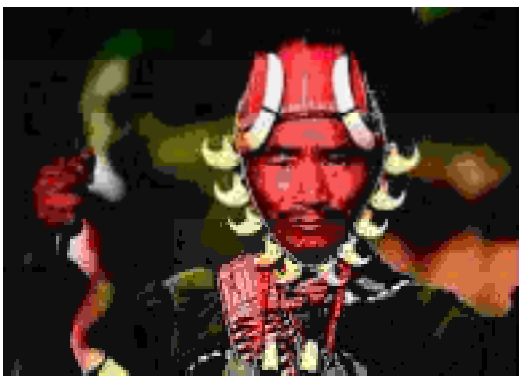
2.1 People of India

The customs of a person are emerged from the society, he belongs. People of different caste, race, religion, language and culture live in India. There are nearly 4635 communities of which 751 are scheduled castes and 461 scheduled tribes. Here 83% are Hindus and others are Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Bodhs, Jains, Parsis and Jews. Apart from these there is aboriginal communities Tribes. They have their own religions, gods - goddesses and rituals. All religions are further divided into various communities.



Peoples of different religions

It is said that Hindus have 33 crores gods whom they worship. Muslims are divided in two sects - Shia and Sunni. Christians are divided in two sects - Catholic and Protestant. Buddhists are divided in two sects - Mahayana and Hinayana and Jain also have two sects - Digamber and Shwetambar. The followers of the Parsi and Jewish religion are less in numbers. Majority of the Parsi's are from Maharashtra and Gujarat and Jews live in Maharashtra and Kerala.



Tribes of India

There are many tribes in India. Around 461 communities of tribes are found in India. They are the descendants of our ancient population. Even today a large part of them have not been able to get their full rights. They are totally different in their culture, religion, social and economic composition. They follow their ancient traditions and are economically backward.

The reservation has been gives to them according to the constitution of India. The population of Gond, Bhil and Santhal tribes is more than 30 lakh. Apart from this, the population of Meena, Munda and Oraon tribe is more than 5 lakh. There are 42 tribes whose population is between 1 lakh to 1.5 Lakh.

Their food habits, attire, way of living and functioning is different from others. Some people from

these tribes still practice hunting of animals and shifting cultivation. Some have prospered and are doing jobs or are self employed.



Tribes of India

Many languages and dialects are spoken in India. There are 544 Languages in this country. Many languages do not have a script. Sanskrit is one of the most important and oldest language of India.

We find Sanskrit words in all the languages. The Indian Constitution accords recognition to 22 Languages. These languages are - Assamese, Bangla, Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali, English, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Kashmiri, Konkani, Malayalam, Manipuri, Marathi, Nepali, Oriya, Punjabi, Sanskrit, Sindhi, Tamil, Telugu and Urdu. The official work of states is done in Hindi, English or regional language.

All religions, castes and regions have different customs, food habits, way of living and dressing. People of all religions follow their customs according to their culture.



Tulsi Pooja

Let's see, what you have learnt 2.1

I. Fill in the blanks

i. People from ..... religions of the world live in India.

ii. Tribes have their own .....

iii. Buddhism is divided in two Sects - Hinayana and .....

II. Write the answer to the questions.

i. Write the names of both sects of the Muslims.

a. ..... b. .....

ii. Write the name of any two tribes.

a. ..... b. .....

2.2 Our Mixed Culture: Unity in Diversity

Followers of different religions live in India. People of different faiths reside here in unity and brotherhood. Several kinds of architecture, sculpture and artwork have developed here. In India, there are many types of folk and classical music and dances. There are many festivals and traditions. This diversity makes the culture of the country common and mixed. It also makes it prosperous and beautiful. Do you know what the reasons are?



Manipuri Dance

Here we have different customs and traditions as well as music and dance, of all religions. The vastness of the country and geographical and climatic differences are one of the reasons for this diversity. From ancient time people from outside have come and settled here. Iranians, Greeks, Kushans, Shakyas, Huns, Arabs, Turks, Mughal and Europeans came here. They settled here, and mingled with the local residents.



Bhangra Dance

They came with their own culture, thoughts and ideas and then they mixed and became familiar with the culture of India. This is the reason of divers Indian Culture. Along with the culture from abroad there has been an exchange of culture from different area of the country. Chikankari items from Lucknow, Phulkari from Punjab, Embroidery from Bengal, Patola from Odisha are now available everywhere. In the same way culture, behaviour and views have also intermingled.



Patola from Odisha

The climate of India is not uniform. Somewhere it is very cold, while in some other place it may be hot or rainy. somewhere hot and somewhere it is rainy. This makes the food, dress, economic activities, crop etc., also different. The mixed nature of our culture can be seen in our music, dance, drama, craft, artwork, sculpture, language and literature also.



Chikankari work from Lucknow

Indian civilization and culture got their diverseness from the customs and practices of people who follow all religions. Our unity has been strengthened by the festivals, feast and celebrations of different religions. Various states of India celebrate festivals like Holi, Diwali, Dushahra, Christmas. Apart from this the birth anniversary of Guru Nanak, Mahavir and Buddha are celebrated as social and religious festivals.



EID

Many festivals are celebrated in different areas under different names like - Makar Sankranti is celebrated as 'Khichri' festival in north India. In Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh it is called 'Lohri', in Assam is Bihu, in southern state of Tamil Nadu as 'Pongal' and in Kerala as 'Onam'. In these festivals we get a glimpse of cultural mix and also see local diversity.



Festival of Holi

In different states their language, dialect, costumes and food also identify our mixed culture.



People Celebrating Lohri

Folk music and Folk dance of different communities also depict our culture. Many types of dances various kinds of songs and music are popular in India. Normally in social functions, weddings, birthdays, we play music, sing songs and dance. What is common between the Bhangra of Punjab and Bihu of Assam? Both are performed to show happiness after a good harvest.

Earlier our country was divided into many princely states. They had cultural similarities but they were not integrated like India of today. Britishers took in to their hands the reins of many



Independence Day

princely states and ruled them. At that time, India was not united. For the first time during the country's independence struggle a feeling of nationalism arose among people. In this struggle, different areas, religions, cultures, communities and sects united themselves. The British power was thrown out of India. The Indian National Congress was formed in 1885 and the people from all parts of the country got together under its banner. British rulers were forced to leave India. The national freedom struggle, make the strong unity among the people. Later in the constitution of India, unity and integrity of the nation were included as one of the main objectives. It was also included in this, that it is the duty of every citizen to work towards the unity and integrity of the nation.

In our country every religion has their own symbols but all are one under the National Flag.

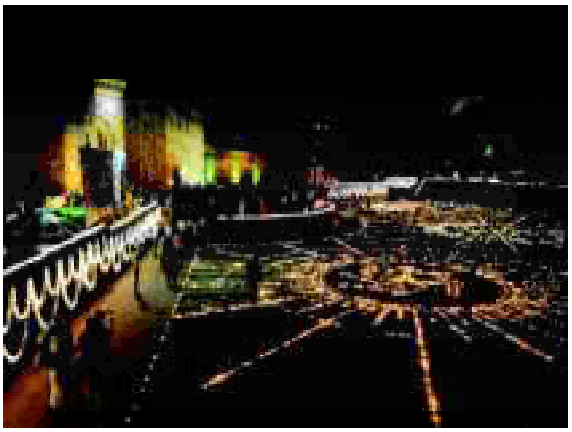
Generally it is said that in India, cricket is like a religion. When our cricket team is playing a match, the whole country is sitting in front of their television. Our cricket players are from different regions of the country, from various social and cultural environments and from different religions but they play as one for the country. We celebrate each win of the Indian cricket team and are disappointed at their loss. This is the national unity. In the same way, in hockey, football and other games there are people from all communities, but being Indian, we celebrate all the victories.



Cricket Match



Durga Puja



Diwali

You must have seen that in our armed forces & police, people from different castes, communities and regions work together. All are given the same type of food & living and they celebrate the festivals with full enthusiasm whether it is Diwali, Holi, Eid, Durgapuja or Ganesh Chaturthi. This depicts the feeling of unity in diversity. When our country is under threat everyone faces it together.

We are the citizens of one common country. When there is a major challenge, whether it is an attack by another country, border disputes, terrorism or an internal problem in the country, we are ready to protect our country. In doing this, we do not think about regionalism, language, religion or sectarianism. At that time we talk about national integration. Our constitution, national flag and national anthem bind the whole country in the thread of unity.



Hoisting of National Flag at Fed Fort

Let's see, what you have learnt 2.2

I. Fill in the blanks:

i. It is the duty of every citizen to work towards the ..... and integrity of the nation.

ii. Soldiers celebrate all the festivals .....

iii. In India people of different language and ..... live.

2.3 Peace and Harmony

Think about your home. Are we living in peace in our homes? Do all the members of the family honor each other's views? Do they give each other enough Importance, as they should receive? If yes, then definitely we are living in peace. We ourselves should live in peace and let our neighbours also live in peace and dignity; then there will be peace in the whole village.

Now think about the families of our relatives, neighbours and people of the village. Are all the



Hoisting of National Flag at Fed Fort

families living in peace? Now see which family is more prosperous and happy. You will observe that families, where people live in peace and harmony are more prosperous. This kind of family prospers and moves ahead.

The same is true for the country. Those countries where there is peace there is development.

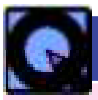
These countries are prospering. The development is hamperd in the countries which are involved in where fights, bloodshed & terrorism. The whole strength of the country is wasted in maintaining peace and lot of money is spent on it, so how will it progress.

If we respect people of all religion, who live in our country then definitely there will be an atmosphere of peace. It is certain that from time to time some people will try to disrupt this peace but they will be successful only if we let them succeed. They will be successful if there is a crack in our unity.

The policy of our country includes peace with all the countries. We will not attack first on our neighbours. Our country has always followed this policy. We have tried to maintain good relations with our neighbors. Even if a dispute arises, we should get together and sort it through dialogues. If all the countries adopt this policy, then there will be peace in the whole world. It is the need of the day.

Harmony means to become soaked in one flavor, that there is no difference, no dispute, no one is small or big, high or low, rich or poor. All are one and equal. There is only one feeling, a feeling of humanity. We should think of everyone as equal, and treat as one with ourselves.

All people are equal in our Constitution. The country's development projects benefits to everyone equally, without any prejudice. In the eyes of the law all are equal.



Let's see, what you have learnt 2.3

Fill in the blanks:

i. We should ..... all religions.

ii. It is our country's policy not to ..... our neighbors.

iii. We have always tried to maintain good ..... with our neighboring countries.

iv. Harmony means to be ..... in one flavor.

v. In our constitution, all people are .....

2.4 The spread of Peace and Goodwill by Emperor Ashoka and Akbar

Nearly 3400 years ago Emperor Ashoka fought the battle of Kalinga. Kalinga is the ancient name

of costal Odisha. There was lot of violence and bloodshed in the battle. Seeing the bloodshed in the battle, Emperor Ashoka was filled with aversion towards it. He decided that in future he would never wage a battle. He was inspired by the teachings of Buddha. He thought that as mother and father teach good behavior to their children, in the same manner, he would guide his people.



Emperor Ashoka

There were many problems in his kingdom. People followed different religions and many times conflict arose among them. Animals were sacrificed. Slaves and servants were treated very cruelly. There were fights in families and among neighbors. Ashoka felt that it was his duty to solve these problems. Therefore, he appointed officers called Dhamma - Mahamattas. They went from place to place to spread the principles of Dhamma.



Battle of Kalinga

Along with this, Ashoka engraved his message on rocks and pillars at many places. Officers were instructed to read these messages to those people who were unable to read them.

Ashoka's message was good behavior towards one's slaves and servants, respect the elders, compassion for all creatures and charity to Brahmins and Monks.

Praising only your religion and criticizing the religion of others, both are improper. Everyone must respect other's religions. If someone is praising his own religion and finding fault in other religions, he is in fact harming his own religion more. Therefore everyone must try to understand the main principles of other religions and pay respect to them.

Emperor Akbar fostered the Hindu-Muslim brotherhood. He gave posts of honour in his court to many Hindu scholars, artists and wazirs. He himself married Jodhabai, a Hindu rajput princess. He gave his wife full freedom and liberty. This way she was able to perform all the customs and traditions of her religion. To maintain mutual feeling of brotherhood Akbar observed a relationship of 'Roti' and 'Beti' with the Hindus. In his palace Hindu and Muslim festivals were celebrated with gusts and without differentiation.



Akbar

To maintain peace and harmony in the society he initiated the faith of 'Sulh Kul' and 'Din-e-Ilahi'. He incorporated the good things of all religions in them. In this way, Akbar emerged as an advocate of secularism.

India is still attached to its past through its customs, religious beliefs and traditions. Today everywhere in the world there is an environment of violence and terror but India is teaching the whole world the lessons of peace, harmony and non-violence. Not only Ashoka and Akbar, in our history, there have been many kings and emperors who have tried to foster brotherhood among the countrymen in every conceivable manner.

Let's see, what you have learnt 2.4

Fill in the blanks;

i. Ashoka appointed officer who were called ..... Mahamatta.

ii. Ashoka engraved his messages on ..... and Pillars.

iii. Everyone must ..... other religions.

iv. To maintain brotherhood Akbar observed a relationship of ..... with the Hindus.

v. Akbar initiated the faith of ..... and Din-I-Ilahi.

Let's Revise

- In India people of different castes, communities and races live.
- There are nearly 4635 communities of which 751 are scheduled caste and 461 scheduled tribe.
- Adivasi's religions, customs, way of living, food etc are different from others.
- In the Indian struggle for independence people from all regions, religions and culture participated.
- National flag and national anthem are a symbol of our national unity.
- In games, armed forces and police the feeling of unity in diversity is strengthened.
- During Ashoka's rule there was a conflict among religions. The treatment towards slaves was cruel. There were many fights. Therefore he adopted Buddhism. He appointed officers called Dhamma-Mahamatta.
- Ashoka's Message - Good behavior, Respect towards elders, compassion for all creatures, charity to Brahmins and monks and respect for all religions.
- Akbar initiated the faith of 'Suleh Kul' and 'Din-e-Ilahi'.

Exercise

I. Fill in the blanks

i. India is the …….. most populated country in the world.

ii. The roots of Indian culture are very ……..

iii. A person's customs rise from the special …….. of which he is a member.

iv. Adivasi's have their own ……..

v. The Indian constitution accords recognition to …… languages.

vi. We are first ……., then anything else.

II. Answer these questions

i. Write the names of major religions of India?

_____

ii. Which religions have come from outside India?

_____

iii. Write two preaching's of Ashoka.

_____

III. Mark (✓) for true and (✗) for false

i. In India, the food and living habits of all religions is same. ( )

ii. Jainism and Buddhism are against caste system. ( )

iii. Followers of all religions of the world, live in India. ( )

ANSWERS

Let's see, what you have learnt

2.1 I. i. All

ii. Gods-Goddesses

iii. Mahayana

II. i. a. Shia

b. Sunni

ii. a. Gond

b. Bhil

2.2 i. Unity

ii. Together

iii. Religions

2.3 i. Respect ii. Attack

iii. Relation iv. Soaked

v. Equal

2.4 i. Dhamma ii. Rocks

iii. Respect iv. Roti and Beti

v. Suleh-Kul

Exercise

I. i. Second ii. Ancient

iii. Culture iv. Gods-goddesses

v. 22 vi. Indians

II. i. Hindu, Muslim, Christian, Sikh, Bodh, Jain, Parsi and Jew.

ii. Islam, Christianity, Parsi and Jewish.

iii. Good behavior, Respect for elders.

III. i. ✘

ii. ✓

iii. ✓

3

Our Social Issues



We will learn in this lesson

- Small family - its principles and significance.
- Significance of education and female literacy.
- Male - female equality.
- Special attention to women.
- Practice of dowry and its related laws.
- Female foeticide.

The society in which we live has a lot of good qualities as well as some shortcomings. Goodness takes us forward but the shortcomings put a stop to our progressive steps. They weaken our society. Some of these shortcomings are - backwardness of women in education, lack of their proper care, women considered less than men, practice of dowry, female foeticide etc. All of these are our social issues. In some way or the other these issues affect our life. They do not let our society progress. One such issue is: - increasing population. Families are large. They are not able to provide proper food and education to all. If we want our society to develop and progress, then we will have to understand these social issues properly. We will have to know what obstacles come in the way and how to remove them.

3.1 Small family - Happy Household

There was a time when a big and complete family was looked upon with respect. It was considered a sign of prosperity. But today this impression has changed.

Now a small family is considered a happy family. Why is it so? Why is there an impression that a small family is a happy family? Come, let's reflect on it.

3.1.1 Problems of a Big Family

- If there are many children in the family their needs will also be more. The cost of Nurturing, up keep, medical treatment and cost of education will be more.
- Limited income will not fulfil properly everyone's needs.
- In ordinary houses if there are more children then their need for education, clothes, food etc will not be well looked after and children cry for small things and you have to deny them.
- When children do not get sufficient balanced diet and nutritious contents, they fall prey to malnutrition and if they fall ill, proper treatment cannot be given to them.
- More children and born in quick succession affect the health of the mother.
- All the children are not able to get complete love and care.



Big Family

- Some children when they grow a little older, turn to wrong to fulfil their needs and desires ways.
- There is tension, discord and aerimony in the family.
- Large farms and houses are divided into small pieces.
- Poverty, unemployment and starvation increase.
- Therefore, an increasing population, finally affects the development and prosperity of the country.
- As a result electricity, water, housing, clothes, cereals, fruits, medicine, jobs, education etc are not enough for everyone. The government has to make a lot of effort to fulfill these needs.
- When population increases the demand for essential items also increases. This leads to inflation, hoarding and black marketing.

3.1.2 Benefit of a small family

- If there are one or two children in the family then they can be nurtured much better.
- Children get full love and affection.
- There is an environment of peace happiness, gaiety and laughter in the family. See photo (Small Family)
- The needs of the children can be fulfilled to a large extent, even in limited income.
- The expenses of food, clothes or education are easy to bear.
- Children can be given balanced and nutritive food, in sufficient quantity. Children and their mothers also remain healthy.
- Less population leads to fast growth of the country.
- Problems of unemployment, poverty and starvation are reduced.
- Basic needs of the people are fulfill easily.
- It is easy to control inflation, hoarding and black-marketing.



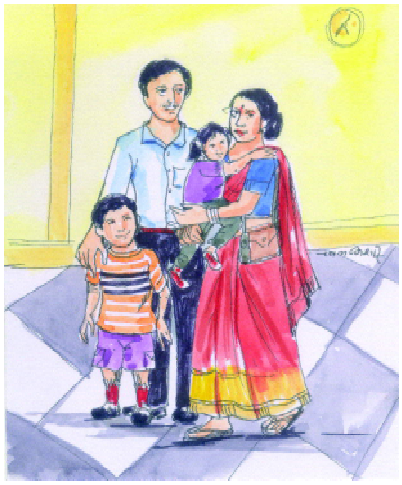
Small Family

We have to think

Below are the pictures of two families, look at them carefully. What is the difference between them?



Big Family



Small Family

Let's see, what you have learnt 3.1

Fill in the blanks;

i. Small family is a ……family.

ii. In a big family children are not able to get …….

iii. If there are one or two children they receive good ……..

iv. In a small family children are able to get …… food.

v. Due to large population unemployment and ……..increases.

3.2 Education is a must for all

In Baiju's family no one in educated, neither he himself, nor his wife, nor his mother and father and nor his children. He is a laborer. Now that the children have become slightly older they have also started working for wages. Dirtiness and poverty is clearly seen in the house. In the family someone or the other is generally frequently ill.



Big Family

On the other hand everyone is educated in Sudhakar's family. His parents, wife and children-all. The status of his family is totally different from Baiju's. His house is always clean and tidy. All things are clean and kept properly. His food habits and standard of living is much better and children also wear neat and clean clothes for school every day.

Not only Baiju and Sudhakar, it we observe that any illiterate and an educated family we will clearly notice the difference. This difference is due to education.

Education is not only reading and writing. Education means gaining knowledge, learning and knowing.

knowledge can be gained in any manner or way like - by seeing, hearing, reading or by practices. If we see it this way education is always a part of our life. A child's education starts with his family. His first teachers are his father and mother. When he grows up and he starts going to school. Reading, writing is a means of his education.

Without going to school or reading and writing the range of education will be limited. Books are

store house of knowledge and information and they contain unlimited knowledge and information. Therefore reading - writing is considered very important, but in our country there are a large number of people who are illiterate. In this the numbers of women are more. The main reason of their is the discrimination exercised against women. In many homes it is not considered important to educate daughters.

Even after so many years of independence the condition of education is not very good. Today also many children are unable to go to school. From childhood, they are sent for work and this happens even when the government provides free education till class eighth. The main reason for this condition is that in many homes, studies are not considered important. There is a lack of awareness among them.

3.2.1 Why is education Important?

- Education increases knowledge and give information about country and world.
- Education makes our lives better. It improves the manner we live and the way we work.
- Education opens door for employment and earnings.
- Education increases understanding and also increase capability to take correct decisions.
- Increase respect and reputation.
- Education makes us self-reliant and improves our self-confidence.
- It makes us aware of our rights and duties.
- It helps to remove - hypocrisy, ostentation, superstition, malpractices and social evils.
- Education increases our acquaintances. It joins people. It strengthens love, brotherhood, unity and integrity of the country.
- And educated society and country progresses and develops faster.
- Education increases the prosperity of the Society and Country. Altogether education helps to make our life happy and prosperous.

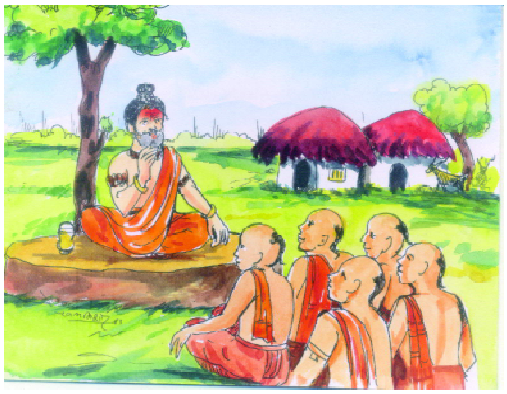
It we see this way, education has lots of benefits. We must reflect on it. Who does not want his life to be better and prosperous? We take innumerable measures and make efforts; for this and still we are lagging behind in the case of education, especially in girl education. In a family, boys are sent to school but girls are involved in the household work all day. It is not considered necessary that they should study. Why so? Why is she not given the right to study? It is required to view it seriously.



Boy going to school, girl working at home

3.2.2 Status of Girl Education

If we look at history of girls' education has from the beginning been neglected. In ancient times, in the Vedic Age, the primary education was given by the family. For higher education there were Gurukul and Ashram. Girls were entitled only to primary education at home. They were not sent to Gurukul or Ashram.



Education in Gurukul

In Buddhist period, education was imparted in Buddhist centers and monasteries. These were near the township. They imparted both primary and higher education but over here also the women were deprived from education. Very few women were given the facility of education.

During the British rule there was no restriction to women's education but there was not much improvement in their condition. At the time of independence, the literacy rate among Indian women was only 8.89%. After independence special emphasis was laid on their education. With this, the condition improved. In spite of this, due to move discrimination against girl, the pace of their education did not quicken. Today also many girls are not sent to school. If every girl of every family goes to school, like boys, she also reads and writes and moves ahead, then only will our society and country develop. This is possible, if we understand the importance of educating girls and do not discriminate against them.



Girl working at home

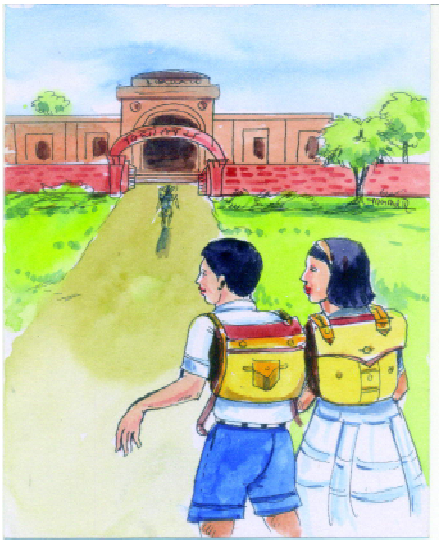
3.2.3 Women's Education and its objective

- Educate women and make them self - reliant and empowered.
- Make them aware of their rights.
- Give birth to a cultured generation and improve standard of living.
- Co-operate in the nation's development.
- Make the home environment pleasant.
- Make them aware of problems related to population and how they can contribute in solving them.

- Prevent social evils.
- Develop women's courage, boldness and leadership qualities.
- Enhance girl's education and change the views of Society.
- Make effective the strength of equality and affection.

3.2.4 What can we do?

- Send our school going children to school.
- Education for girls is very important. Do not discriminate against them. Give full opportunity to them to read and write.
- If any child of our friend or neighbor is not going to school, we should try to persuade their father and mother. Help them to send the child to school.
- Like food, clothing, house, medicine and other essential things, education is also our main requirement. Do not overlook it.
- Boy or girl, we must educate them according to their wishes and capabilities. For this we may have to cut other expenses.
- Persons, who have crossed the school going age and have not been able to study, should join literacy programs to read and write. After learning from literacy program, they can continue their education through the medium of National Institute of Open Schooling.



Children going to school

- Create a good atmosphere and provide facilities for the child's studies. Give them enough time to study and practise at home.
- Give maximum importance to education because it upgrades your life and is a means of earning and employment.

Let's see, what you have learnt 3.2

Fill in the blanks from the given words.

Way, Store-house, Mother -Father, Helpful, Life

i. The first teacher of the child is …….

ii. Books ……. Knowledge and information.

iii. Education opens the …….. for employment and earning.

iv. Education upgrades……..

v. Education is …… in making life pleasant.

3.3 Men - Women Equality

Women are the basis of all creation. They are the backbone of the family. There was a time in Indian Society when women were treated with honor and respect. Women were revered. It is also written in the Vedas and Puranas that where a women are worshipped, there gods reside. No yajna is complete without the presence of women. Women perform her duties in the form of a daughter, daughter - in - law, mother, grandmother and sister. Mothers and grandmothers tell the children stories of character building. They imbibe values in future generation. Mother is the child's first teacher. India's history tells us that there were many brave and learned women who left the man behind like Durgawati, Mirabai, Padmini, Jeejabai, Ahilyabai and Rani Laxmibai.

In society, women hold such a respectable place and still they are neglected. In Indian society there are two kinds of status. On one side women reach extreme heights. They are on good posts. On the other hand in rural and remote areas their status is worrisome. In the family women are looked down upon. They can't open their mouth in front of men. A man can roam anywhere day & night but a woman cannot step out of her house. She cannot wear and dress up as she wants. Women have not got an equal honor.

There are many reasons for this -

Social System: In Indian society some traditions are followed from generation after generation. Daughters are married off and they go to another home. The boy takes care of the family and the girl is considered someone else's property. A boy's birth is celebrated but when a girl is born everyone feels dejected.



Celebration at boy's birth.

Before marriage parents discriminate against girls and after marriage they become victims of dowry, purdah and domestic violence.

Economic Freedom: In our society majority of the women are economically weak. Even after working day and night they are empty handed. Even for small needs they have to beg before men. With the passage of time, some women have

stepped over the thresh-hold to earn their living but they are still not free from the state of making & serving food.



Women working in the fields.

Men Dominated Society: Our Society is men dominated. Any new work in the house, arranging a marriage, buying property etc. everything is decided by men. Women are not consulted in this.

Illiteracy: In our society even today most of the women are uneducated. Due to lack of education and ignorance they are facing problems of childs, marriage, unequal marriage, dowry, gender discrimination, superstition, purdah practice, rape, exploitation and domestic violence.

Our thinking is if a girl goes out of the house she gets spoilt. She is therefore not sent far from the village to study. When the girls become a little older they start talking about her marriage. Like this, how can she become equal to men?



Poverty in a large family

Poverty: In our country many families are struggling with the problems of poverty. Generally, they go to sleep hungry. Because of the poverty, the females of the house have to go out to earn wages. Girls are not able to go to school.

Population: Since our society poverty goes on increasing due to a big family is male dominated, the desire for a son is more and this desire results in the birth of many children. Children are not able to receive education and sufficient food. The disadvantage of a big family is especially suffered by the girls.

Social Thinking: In our society, in a majority of places there is a wrong thinking about women. They are considered weak and helpless. Their brilliance, potentials and talent are not given any importance.



Women busy in house-hold work.

Let's see, what you have learnt 3.3

Fill in the blanks:

i. A woman is the …… of the family.

ii. A mother is considered the child's first …….

iii. In our society most of the women are economically ……..

iv. Mother and grandmother tell the children …….. of character building.

v. When a …… is born, people feel dejected.

3.4 Special attention to Girls

A mother is the family's pivotal point. If she is educated, not only will the whole family become educated, rather there will be an awakening in society. This is the reason why so much emphasis is being laid on women's education. For developing the personality of girls, special facilities are being given to them in different areas. This is fast changing their status. They are progressing fast in different areas.

1. Progress in the field of Education

According to census of the year 1961 male literacy was 40% and female literacy was just 15%. In the past few decades, female literacy has taken a quantum leap. In 1971 female literacy rate was 22% which gradually increased to 65.46% in 2011. This tremendous change is due to the fact that girls especially from poor families are given a lot of benefits. To bring them into the mainstream of society, government has adopted a number of steps for girls as an incentive like free books, free uniform, scholarship, free midday meals, convenience of a hostel and 'Ladli' program. Boys and girls in the age group of 6 to 14 years are provided free and compulsory education. Right to education legislation which was passed by parliament was a revolutionary step in the field of education for all.

Ministry of Human Resource Development under the National Literacy Mission started the 'Sakshaar Bharat' program and their full emphasis was on women's education. Under the aegis of this program by 2017, 80% of the women of the country will be made literate.

2. Progress in political Sphere

Initial stand in the form of the first steps of a democracy is participation of women in Panchayats and Municipalities. The 73rd constitutional amendment bill gives one-third reservation to women in the Panchayats. Now women are elected in larger numbers. The Central Cabinet is working towards increasing reservation for women from one third to fifty percent. Commission